

Interference tactics: Black, move 22

Interference tactics

Black to move

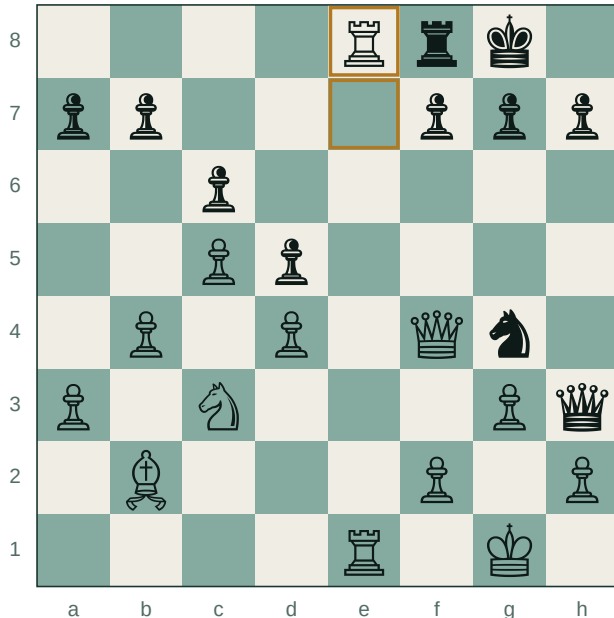
WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b2. Check for tactical protection.



Previous move: 22.Rxe8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22...Qxh2+ 23. Kf1 Qh1+ 24. Ke2 Rxe8+

22...Qxh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h2. Recorded reply: **23.Kf1**.

23...Qh1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **24.Ke2**.

24...Rxe8+ Check restricts White to 7 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -8 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.